only brought India goodwill in the international community but also demonstrated the fact that as an important country in the vaccine supply chain, India was giving back as much as it was receiving. Let me explain. Vaccines are complex to manufacture and depend on a host of specifically engineered raw materials from around the world. For instance, the Pfizer COVID-19 vaccine reportedly depends on 280 ingredients and components sourced from 86 suppliers in 19 countries. Similarly, COVID-19 vaccines manufactured in India need about 360 ingredients sourced from over 10 countries. Over 200 of these ingredients are sourced from the US, about 100 from Germany and the rest from Singapore, Denmark, Poland and Japan. Supply chains of this entire ecosystem came to be disrupted when COVID-19 hit the world and the manufacturers of these ingredients had to significantly scale up to the sudden need—still falling short to meet demand. In such a scenario, where all manufacturers around the world were vying for the same ingredients, they were made available to India on priority mainly because India is an important link in the chain—both as a supplier of ingredients and the finished vaccines. The fact that India makes cost-effective vaccines for its own people as well as for countries across the globe makes us a tenable part of this global vaccine network. To ensure that India gets priority in the supply of ingredients, our diplomats worked aggressively with partner countries. To give you an example, the US had instituted an executive export embargo under the Defense Production Act (DPA) of 1950 across categories which would disallow raw materials from being exported. Adar Poonawalla even tweeted to that effect on 16 April, ‘Respected @POTUS, if we are to truly unite in beating this virus, on behalf of the vaccine industry outside the U.S., I humbly request you to lift the embargo of raw material exports out of the U.S. so that vaccine production can ramp up. Your administration has the details.’[47] In order to ensure that our supplies were not disrupted, our diplomats worked closely with the US government behind the scenes to persuade it to lift the embargo. Given the excellent bilateral ties between the two countries, which have deepened considerably under Prime Minister Modi, the US suggested that India give them a specific list of ingredients which we would require the embargo to be lifted on. After working with the government, the Indian diplomats then went into individual manufacturers of the requisite raw materials, providing estimated quantities and a sound plan for them to be able to prioritize supplying to India. The prime minister, too, spoke with